ENG 2003 - Effective Engineering Communication

Assignment 4 - Technical Presentation (5% of final grade)
Due April 6th, 2026 (11:59pm)

Summary: For Assignment 4, you will be recording a technical presentation in 4- or 5-person groups. This document (1) identifies the associated learning outcome; (2) offers detailed guidelines and instructions for the presentation; and (3) details how the presentation will be assessed.

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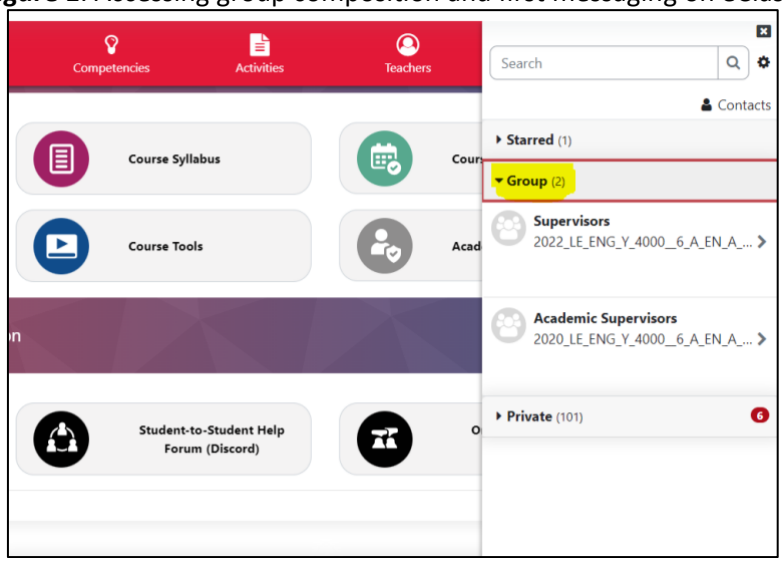
1. Learning Outcome: Effectively present engineering material orally using a variety of techniques and methods (CL05).

2. Guidelines/Instructions: To complete this assignment, you must (i) make contact with your assigned group; (ii) select a topic and create a work-plan/outline; (iii) create a PowerPoint presentation; (iv) record your presentation; and (v) submit your PowerPoint presentation and presentation recording via the submission page on eClass. Guidelines and instructions for each of these steps are provided below.

i. Make contact with your assigned group: You will be randomly assigned to 4- or 5-person groups through eClass. You are responsible for contacting your group members via email to coordinate a first meeting, either in person or virtually.

Figure 1: Accessing group composition and first messaging on eClass.



- Students are encouraged to reach out to their assigned group members as soon as possible and should be regularly checking their emails.
- The details of your group and first communications can be found by selecting the 'messaging bubble' icon >> 'Group' >> 'Assignment 4'. (Figure 1, above).

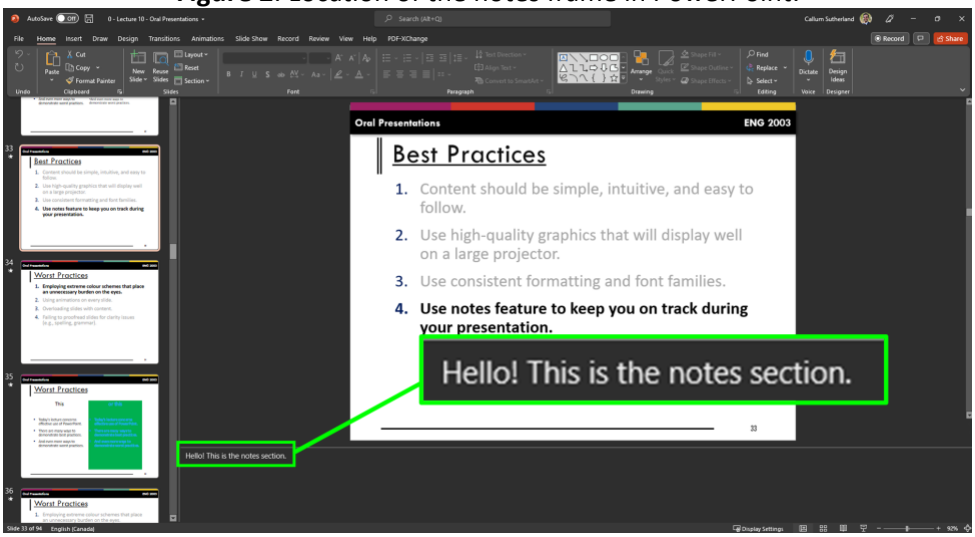
ii. Select a topic and create a work-plan/outline: When meeting with your group, you will be required to select a presentation topic as well as to create a work plan and outline.

- Your team will need to specify a chosen method(s) of communication and/or file-sharing (e.g., Dropbox, WhatsApp, Microsoft Teams, Google Drive, etc.).
- As a group, you should discuss your respective submissions for Term Project 1, and select one of those submissions to serve as your presentation topic.
- Your group will then determine who will be working on each section of the presentation, and create a point-form outline for that section.
- Note that each member of the group should be assigned to at least one section.

<u>iii. Create a PowerPoint presentation:</u> Your submission must include a PowerPoint presentation, including speaker notes.

- Speaker notes (see 2 below) must be included for each slide in your presentation, except for the title slide and references slide (as, typically, these slides are not explicitly addressed by speakers during the presentation).
- The speaker notes should include *brief* talking points that will be used for each slide – that is, the notes should not contain a full script to be recited by speakers.
- Your title slide should contain **<u>the date of your presentation</u>** along with the **<u>full names</u>** and **<u>student numbers</u>** of **<u>every member of your group</u>** that participated in the assignment.
- If member(s) of your group did not participate in this assignment, please add a note (see **Figure** below) to the title slide that states the following: "*The following group member(s) did not participate in this assignment:*" followed by the full names of the group members.

Figure 2: Location of the notes frame in PowerPoint.



<u>iv. Record your presentation:</u> Using Zoom, record your presentation to produce a video containing both your slideshow and the face of the active speaker.

- Your presentation must be **<u>7-8 minutes in length</u>**. Your group will lose marks if your presentation is shorter than seven minutes, or longer than eight.
- Each participating group member should speak for roughly the same amount of time, and their face should be visible in the recording as they are speaking. For this reason, group members who are not speaking should be muted (i.e., so that the active speaker's face remains on the screen).

- Ideally, the presentation should be completed while the group is together (i.e., on the same Zoom call). If necessary, however, you can combine multiple recordings provided that you are submitting just one video file (i.e., separate recordings must be edited together).
- Note that one group member will need to be responsible for sharing their screen and advancing the slides. Your group may want to discuss cues so that this individual will know when to advance to the next slide/animation. That is, for each slide, the speaker could deliver a line which summarizes its contents and indicates that it's time to advance to the next slide (e.g., "…and that's the problem this presentation is trying to address." *advance slide*). Ideally, in other words, you should not be saying "next slide, please" during your presentation.
- Your presentation will be assessed for content (i.e., slides, notes, and information conveyed by speakers) as well as presentation quality. Though you will be graded as a group, individual performance will be assessed in particular areas as well. For this reason, each slide should ***clearly identify*** the full name of the group member responsible for speaking to the contents of that slide. This will help the TAs assign individual marks appropriately. See the rubric below for additional details.

v. Submit your slides and presentation: Please upload your submission files though the Assignment 4 submission link on eClass.

- Your submission package should consist of (1) Slide Deck with Speaker Notes, and (2) Video Recording of the Presentation.
- Each group member should submit individually.
- The Slide Deck should be in a .ppt, .pptx, or .pdf format and the file name should be formatted as: **YourLastName_YourFirstName_assign4_group#_slides.[extension]** (example: "*John_Doe_assign4_group12_slides.pptx*").
- The video recording should be a 100MB or less file (avi, mpeg etc) OR a publicly-accessible URL to your video file (echo360, Youtube etc). The file name (and video title if applicable) should be formatted as: **YourLastName_YourFirstName_assign4_group#_recording[.extension]** (example: "*Jane_Doe_assign4_group9_recording.avi*".)

The rubric for Assignment 4 is found on the next two pages.

3. Assessment details: The rubric for this assignment is as follows.

Part 1 - Slides Content, Speaker Notes & Pacing (Marked as a Group)				
Marks	**0-1**	**2-3**	**4-5**	**TOTAL**
Problem Statement / Clarity of Purpose (slides and speaker notes)	Purpose of problem not displayed in the slides. Audience is confused as to why project/report was undertaken.	Goal and purpose of problem is addressed. The discussion content is reasonably clear but not compelling/persuasive.	Provided an accurate and persuasive description of goals and purpose of the report.	/5
Content and Results (slides and speaker notes)	Failed to discuss the meaning of the results / reasons for conclusions. Lacked creativity and/or practical engineering.	Mentioned a few results/ reasons for final choice in the speaker notes, giving the results only limited context. Showed some creativity and practical engineering design/decision making.	Good explanation and justification for results/ outcomes in the slides and speaker notes. Context is clear to the audience. Showed both creativity and practicality in design/results/discussion/etc.	/15
Visual Aids (slides)	Slides are difficult to read and follow. (e.g., poor colour scheme, not logical flow, too much text, etc.)	Slides are aesthetically pleasing (good colour scheme, appropriate flow, manageable text on slides)	Excellent use of PowerPoint as an aid to presentation purposes. Put into practice lessons learned in class such as appropriate color schemes, appropriate use of visualization types/techniques, and consistent font families.	/20
Pace/Timing (Group)	Presenters frequently had poor pace (spoke too fast, too slow). Presentation was much too short or too long. (> 1 min threshold)	Some individual presenters kept good pace, however it differed between group members. Presentation was a little bit over /under time (< 1 min threshold)	Overall, the group kept a good and consistent speaking speed. Presentation was the right length.	/15

Part 2 of the rubric is on the next page.

Part 2 – Presentation Quality (Marked Individually)					
Marks		**0-1**	**2-3**	**4-5**	**TOTAL**
Visuals	**Non-verbal / Facial language (Individual)**	Presenter had poor eye contact, inappropriate facial expressions, excessive fidgeting, and movement (pacing, hand gestures, etc.).	Presenter overall made occasional eye contact, mostly appropriate facial expressions, and limited excessive fidgeting and movement.	Presenter maintained excellent eye contact, appropriate facial expressions, and no fidgeting.	/15
Vocals	**Professionalism (Individual)**	Presenter appeared and handled themself unprofessionally (appearance, attitude, etc.). Poor volume (too loud, or too quiet).	Presenter appearance and demeanor was mostly professional (appearance, attitude, etc.). Adequate volume.	Presenter was extremely professional in their appearance, demeanor, manners, and attitude	/15
	Language (Individual)	Presenter used excessive fillers (Um's & Uh's), and often made poor word choices.	Presenter sometimes used fillers, with some lapses in word choice.	Presenter rarely used fillers. Excellent word choice. Strongly followed the 7 C's.	/15
NOTE: up to **-**30 pt penalty if group members (title page) and slide speaker is not identifiable by written text during the recording.				**TOTAL**	/100